
PROFOUND NOVELTY · AMENDMENT A4

The Failure Census

Three dead theories — phlogiston, the luminiferous ether, the epicycle tradition — coded point by point against the nine-point signature under a pre-registered sampling rule. A control for the survivor-selected doctrine: which points discriminate, which are confounded, and what the signature becomes after the dead have voted.

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PHLOGISTON · THE LUMINIFEROUS ETHER · THE EPICYCLE
TRADITION

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1. The Mandate: The Signature Owes a Control

The audit that produced this document's mandate was specific about the crime. Volume IV's fourth alarm — consensus-cozy — fired in part because three volumes of evidence ran one direction: nine revered survivors, selected in part for being the stories the corpus most likes to tell about itself, with no control group and no sampling rule, supporting a doctrine about what profundity feels like when it arrives. Darwin's sentence, quoted at the audit's own crisis point, is the standing indictment: all observation must be for or against some view if it is to be of any service. Three volumes of observation were all for. This document is the scheduled payment — the failure census, Amendment A4, executed against the dead rather than the revered.

A census is not a list of famous defeats, and the difference matters enough to state as a definition. A control group exists to hold something fixed while something else varies, so that the variation can be attributed to what varied and to nothing else. Volume II already ran one removal experiment in this spirit: Mendel, Wegener, and Semmelweis were live theories whose conditions were removed, and the latency of their uptake measured what the conditions carry. The census is the mirror experiment, run from the other side: dead theories, coded against the same instrument that was fitted to the living, holding fixed everything a dead theory shares with the survivor that killed it — the instruments, the data, often the personnel — while the framework itself varies. In the matched pair, the framework is the only variable. That is the cleanest attribution this corpus can construct without a laboratory, and it is precisely the attribution the signature has never faced: every point of the nine-point signature is a claim to discriminate profundity from its imitation, and not one point has ever been tested against the dead.

What the census decides is therefore narrow and sharp. Each of the nine points will be coded, cell by cell, with named evidence, for each of three dead theories: satisfied, partial, or failed. A point the dead satisfy as readily as the living carries no discriminative information — it marks ambition, or stakes, or the general dynamics of research programs, but not profundity — and must be demoted, restated, or operationalized. A point the dead fail is a discriminator, provided its coding is prospective enough to have been applied before anyone knew how the story ended. The census's output is thus not a verdict on the dead, who need none; it is a verdict on the instrument: which of its nine claims survive contact with the control group. The coder's standing is stated here as well, because it is the census's deepest limit: the coding was performed by the signature's own author, who knew the intended answers; no blinding was possible; and the executable fix — independent recoding by a process that has not read the first two volumes — is scheduled by this document rather than performed by it. Chapter 6 returns to that confession at full weight, as the audit's rules of engagement require.

2. The Sampling Rule and the Matched Pairs

A sampling rule written after the coding is a costume, so the rule is written first, applied second, and printed in between. Four criteria. First, dominance: the theory must have been the framework of record in at least one major discipline for no fewer than three generations of practitioners — roughly seventy-five years — so that the census registers frameworks and not fashions. Second, death: no working scientist now holds it as the literal structure of the world, though its machinery may survive as mathematics and its instruments may remain in service — death of ontology, not necessarily of apparatus. Third, the match: its executioner must be a member of the surviving case base, and the pair must share instruments and data in the strong sense — the discovery that armed the executioner was made inside the dead theory's own program, by its own defenders, using its own questions. Fourth, the confession: the coder's conflict of interest is stated rather than hidden, and the recoding protocol ships with the deliverable. Applied to the historical record, the rule admits exactly three pairs, stated in Table 1 and drawn in Figure 1: phlogiston against Lavoisier's oxygen chemistry, the luminiferous ether against Einstein's relativity, and the epicycle tradition against the Newtonian settlement that Kepler's ellipse opened.

The matched-pair design is what makes the census a natural experiment rather than a pageant of famous corpses, and its logic deserves its own paragraph. Priestley isolated oxygen in 1774 as a loyal phlogistonian, read it as dephlogisticated air, carried the samples and the reading to Paris, and handed Lavoisier the instrument of phlogiston's destruction: the same gas, the same balances, the same observations, two vocabularies. Michelson built his interferometer to detect the ether that the Fresnel program demanded, and the null result it returned became relativity's doorway; Bradley's telescope, Fizeau's water tube, and the 1887 experiment are one instrument lineage, serving first the dead theory and then its executioner. Tycho's observatory refined the archive the Ptolemaic tradition had itself assembled, and Kepler consumed the same Mars data to delete the circle from the heavens. In each pair the measurements are held constant and only the framework varies, which is the attribution the signature has always lacked. And the shared instruments cut a second way that the census must also record: the dead theories were not stupid. They were the working physics of their centuries. A control group this strong is an asset — whatever the dead fail is failed by theories that once ran whole disciplines.

Discovery commences with the awareness of anomaly, i.e., with the recognition that nature has somehow violated the paradigm-induced expectations that govern normal science.

Thomas S. Kuhn, *The Structure of Scientific Revolutions*, 1962 — the shared instrument of every pair in this census: the anomaly both sides read, differently.

What the rule does not fix is fame, and an honest census names its own residual confound at the point of claim. The three pairs are also the three most celebrated dead theories in the corpus — the mirror image

of revering survivors — and a reader may suspect that reputation, not the match, did the selecting. The design answer is that the third criterion selects on pair structure, which fame does not supply: the requirement that the executioner's weapon be a discovery made inside the dead program, by its defenders, is structural and checkable. The fuller answer is procedural: the rule is repeatable. Widen the survivor base by Volume II's method — miasma theory pairs with germ theory the moment germ theory enters the case base — and the census re-runs under the same criteria, with the same coding manual, and prints whatever differs. Until that extension is executed, the fame confound stands as named, and every claim below carries it.

Dead theory (control)	Executioner (case base)	The discovery made inside the dead program
Phlogiston, 1703–1780s	Lavoisier's oxygen chemistry	Priestley's oxygen, 1774 — isolated by a loyalist, read as dephlogisticated air, handed to Lavoisier; the shared balance that weighed calcined metals
The luminiferous ether, 1678–1905	Einstein's relativity	Michelson's interferometer, built 1887 to detect the medium — the null result arming the executioner; Bradley's and Fizeau's lineage shared by both
The epicycle tradition, 150–1609	Newton's mechanics (via Kepler)	Tycho's archive — the record assembled for the tradition's next refinement, consumed by Kepler to delete the circle

Table 1 — The census under its rule: three matched pairs, each holding instruments and data constant while the framework varies.

The Matched Pairs — A Natural Experiment

The framework is the only variable: instruments and data held constant, fate varies.

DEAD THEORY (CONTROL)	SHARED INSTRUMENTS AND DATA	EXECUTIONER (CASE BASE)
Phlogiston Stahl, 1703 – 1780s. Combustion, calcination, respiration unified; parameters only, no constant, no formalism. CODED: SOFT POINTS S, HARD POINTS F	PRIESTLEY'S OXYGEN, 1774 Isolated by a phlogiston loyalist, read as dephlogisticated air, handed to Lavoisier in Paris — same gas, same balances, same calx. ◀ ARMS ▶	Lavoisier — Oxygen Chemistry Conservation of mass as the minted measurable; the balance becomes a principle. VOL II CASE
The Luminiferous Ether Huygens 1678, Fresnel 1818 – 1905. Optics and electromagnetism in one medium; complete formalism, incoherent meaning. CODED: SOFT POINTS S, HARD POINTS F	THE MICHELSON NULL, 1887 The interferometer built to detect the medium; Bradley's aberration and Fizeau's tube in the same lineage — three experiments, three ethers. ◀ ARMS ▶	Einstein — Relativity Proper time and the interval as minted measurables; the null read as absence of a needed entity. VOL I CASE
The Epicycle Tradition Apollonius – Ptolemy 150 – 1609. Fourteen centuries of fitted circles; parameters without invariants; devices later reborn as Fourier. CODED: SOFT POINTS S, HARD POINTS F	TYCHO'S ARCHIVE The record assembled for the tradition's next refinement; the same Mars data consumed by Kepler to delete the circle from the heavens. ◀ ARMS ▶	Kepler – Newton Mechanics Circularity deleted as a constitutive concept; G forced by the unification of apple and Moon. VOL I CASE

Each executioner's weapon was discovered inside the dead theory's own program, by its own defenders.

What the pairs hold fixed: instruments, data, personnel. What varies: the vocabulary in which the observation is written — and the fate.

Figure 1 — The matched pairs as natural experiments: the discovery that killed each dead theory was made inside its own program. Framework varies; instruments and data do not.

3. Phlogiston: The First Pair

The phlogiston theory entered chemistry as a renaming and left it as a lesson, and both facts matter to the coding. Becher had proposed a fiery earth in combustible matter; Stahl, from 1703, renamed it phlogiston and gave the concept its career: combustion as release, calcination as slower release, respiration as the release that clears a room of phlogiston-laden vapors, metals as compounds of calx plus phlogiston, charcoal as nearly the pure principle itself. For eighty years this was not a fringe doctrine but the working chemistry of Europe — the vocabulary in which the century's best experiments were designed, reported, and argued. And its genuine explanatory reach is the first datum of the census: the theory unified combustion, rusting, smelting, and respiration under one principle at a time when nothing else did, and the unification was not rhetoric. It is the reason the theory held the field for three generations of practitioners, and it is the reason the census begins with it: the soft points of the signature were paid for here, in full, by a theory that is now a museum exhibit.

Coded against the signature, the first half of the ledger reads as follows. Deletion at birth: failed — phlogiston deleted no constitutive concept; it renamed Becher's principle, added a substance, and left the framework it inherited standing, so that the protocol's own first alarm, renaming, fires at the theory's

christening. Unification: satisfied — the census's first confounded point, satisfied at full strength by a dead theory. Universal constant: failed — the theory had no quantitative core whatever, and its single sustained encounter with measurement is the humiliation of the corpus: metals gain weight when they calcine although phlogiston supposedly leaves them, and the program's answers — that the departing phlogiston carried negative weight, that buoyant inflammable air was phlogiston itself — are parameter-fitting in exactly the sense Volume IV's second alarm defined, executed a century before the alarm was written. Derivation-first: failed as operationalized — each new gas was retrofitted, its properties assigned to phlogiston's departure or arrival after the fact; content was adjusted where structure should have been derived. Conservative embedding: failed — when the oxygen chemistry came, phlogiston was deleted without remainder; no successor recovers it as a limit of anything, and the single word that survives, dephlogisticated, survives the way a fossil survives — as an index of what the vocabulary once contained.

The chemists have made of phlogiston a vague principle, which is not rigorously defined, and which consequently adapts itself to every explanation required of it: a veritable Proteus, changing its form at every instant.

Antoine Lavoisier, “Sur la combustion en général”, 1783 — the executioner's coding of the dead theory, written while it still held the chairs.

The second half of the ledger is where the confounds concentrate, and the census reports them without softening. Formalism and meaning: failed — no formalism ever existed to be detached from a meaning, and no measurable quantity was ever minted by the theory; the one measurable it brushed against, weight, is the one that killed it. Founders' resistance: satisfied — Priestley defended phlogiston to his death in 1804, publishing rebuttals of the oxygen chemistry into the new century, and the census marks the point confounded on the spot: resistance prices the stakes of a vocabulary, not the direction of the truth, because the founders of the profound theories resisted too. Generative slope: positive then negative — the theory's defenders discovered hydrogen, oxygen, nitrogen, and the gas family that became chemistry's instrument panel, a genuinely generative half-century; then the same program began paying for each new phenomenon with a new property of phlogiston, the degenerating phase that Lakatos's criterion would later name. Crisis-chaining: partial — the theory closed the question of why metals share properties and opened the question of what air does to fire, and the crisis it opened is the one that killed it: the air questions were productive, but for the successor, not for the opener.

Read as a pair, the phlogiston–Lavoisier experiment holds its instruments constant with a completeness the other pairs approach but do not match. The gas was the same gas; Priestley's dephlogisticated air and Lavoisier's active ingredient were the same samples, carried across in Paris, weighed on the same balances, driven out of the same red calx; what varied was the vocabulary in which the observation was written. One framework read the gas as ordinary air emptied of a departing principle that no balance could register; the other read it as an element whose combinations explain the same facts without remainder, and whose conservation through every reaction turned the balance from an instrument into a

principle — the conservation of mass was the successor's minted measurable, the quantity phlogiston never had. The pattern the first pair establishes is the one the census will test twice more: the dead theory satisfies the soft points and fails the hard ones, and the failure that matters is not error but this — that nothing in it forced anything, because everything in it could be adjusted.

4. The Ether: The Second Pair

The luminiferous ether was the load-bearing wall of physics for longer than physics has been professional, and the census codes it with the respect that fact deserves. Inherited from Aristotle's fifth element through Descartes's plenum, made necessary for optics by Huygens — waves require a medium — and made quantitative by Fresnel, it became in the nineteenth century the substrate of the two greatest theories that century produced: the wave theory of light and Maxwell's electromagnetism, both of which were, in their own self-understanding, mechanics of the ether. Its defenders' list is the century's honor roll; its questions — what the medium is made of, how it moves, what drags it — were the program's central questions, and the elastic-solid programs of Kelvin and others reached for matter itself. A control group this strong is a gift to the census: whatever the ether fails, it fails as the working framework of the most productive century in the history of physics.

Coded against the signature. Deletion at birth: failed — the ether is the census's purest case of inheritance; it replaced no predecessor's constitutive concept, it was the predecessor's concept, carried forward through the medium-borne propagation default that the protocol's own first phase cites as its canonical example of an inherited, unexamined, load-bearing assumption. Unification: satisfied — one medium under optics and electromagnetism, with the mechanical programs attempting to extend the unification to matter itself: the second pair, second confirmation of the confound. Universal constant: failed for the medium — and the near miss is instructive. The one universal constant in the neighborhood, c , belonged to the field equations and outlived the medium, so that the ether's relation to the founding constants is the inverse of the signature's demand: the constant survived its theory rather than being installed by it. The ether's own parameters — the drag coefficient, the elastic moduli, the contraction factor — were fitted to each anomaly and abandoned with it. Derivation-first: failed — the medium was postulated by analogy with sound in air, assumed to make wave propagation sayable; the genuine derivation of the era, Maxwell's deduction that electromagnetic waves travel at the measured speed of light, belonged to the field theory and stayed with what survived. Conservative embedding: failed — relativity recovered the medium as no limit of anything; the Lorentz–FitzGerald contraction, which held the ether to the Michelson null, was the patch, and the protocol's patch-thickness ledger counts the program's sequence — Fresnel's drag of 1818, Fizeau's partial convection of 1851, the contraction of 1889 — as its canonical worked example.

The remaining points produce the census's richest single finding. Formalism and meaning: partial, and the partial is the problem. By 1904 the program possessed Lorentz's transformations — a complete and, as it proved, correct formalism — while the meaning the formalism was to carry, a mechanical medium with a frame really at rest, never received a coherent measurement story. Bradley's aberration demanded a

stationary ether; Fizeau's experiment demanded partial drag; the Michelson–Morley null demanded contraction: three discriminating experiments prescribing three different ethers — a discriminating list that returned incoherence instead of a number. The point as Volume I wrote it — formalism detached from meaning, the Lorentz failure — is therefore satisfied by the dead theory itself: the confound in its sharpest form, and the reason the point survives only in the operationalized form the audit's sixth amendment gave it, which requires the formalism to mint new measurables and to hold one coherent discriminating list. The ether achieved neither: its instruments measured the ether, and none were made possible by it. Founders' resistance: satisfied — Lorentz kept the preferred-frame reading of his own transformations; Poincaré died in 1912 still holding the medium's armature; the confound deepens, three pairs running. Generative slope: positive then negative, on a heroic scale — Fresnel's optics, the ether-mechanics program that carried Maxwell's equations, and the interferometer itself belong to the generative phase, and the instrument lineage deserves its own sentence: Michelson's device, built to detect this dead theory, took its final descendant form in LIGO, which in 2015 detected gravitational waves — the instrument built for the ether outlived it by a century and found a different universe. Then the incoherence triangle, and the slope turned. Crisis-chaining: partial — the medium closed the problem of action at a distance for optics and electromagnetism, and opened the question of its own state of motion; the crisis it opened killed it, and the null result became relativity's doorway: productive again, and again for the successor.

More careful reflection teaches us, however, that the special theory of relativity does not compel us to deny the ether.

Albert Einstein, "Ether and the Theory of Relativity", Leiden, 1920 — the executioner declining to forbid the noun; the ontology had already died of disuse.

Read as a pair, the ether–relativity experiment shares its instruments down the lineage: Bradley's telescope, Fizeau's water tube, Michelson's interferometer — one line of apparatus, first the dead theory's evidence, then its executioner's. The same null result that the Fresnel program absorbed by shortening its medium's dimension was, in the successor's vocabulary, no result at all — the absence of a needed entity rather than a property of a present one — and the distance between those two readings is exactly the distance the signature's sixth point operationalizes. What the ether never achieved is what its executioner achieved first: quantities that instruments could be built to measure because the theory demanded them — proper time read off a moving clock, the interval behind two events — where the ether offered only its own parameters to adjust. The pattern of the first pair repeats with one sharpening: this dead theory had the formalism and failed the meaning, which is the Lorentz failure itself, and the census codes the point accordingly — partial as written, discriminating only operationalized.

5. Epicycles: The Third Pair

The epicycle tradition is the oldest, longest-lived, and most instructive of the three dead theories, and the census codes it with the humility its career imposes. From Apollonius through Hipparchus to Ptolemy's *Almagest*, and through the Islamic and European refinements that followed for fourteen centuries, the deferent-epicycle-equant construction was the computational engine of astronomy — the machine that turned the Babylonian and Greek archives into calendars, eclipse tables, navigation, and the trigonometry the rest of science inherited. It was, by a wide margin, the most successful data-driven research program of the pre-telescopic world, its parameters fitted to records reaching back before the theory itself. Whatever the census says about it, it says about the program that ran the longest productive career in this study — longer than the survivor side's entire case base combined — and that fact disciplines every row that follows.

Coded against the signature. Deletion at birth: failed — the tradition extended the devices of Eudoxus and Hipparchus; uniform circular motion was not a conclusion it drew but the inherited frame within which it never once looked up. Unification: satisfied — one construction for all seven wanderers, the first great unification of astronomical content under a single formal device: the third pair, third confirmation, and the census records the confound as structural — every ambitious program in its heroic phase unifies. Universal constant: failed, and the failure is the purest in the corpus — parameters in the dozens (radii, epochs, phases, eccentricities, per planet), invariants zero; a machine of fitted circles with no quantity that any instrument could measure independently of the fit. This is the fitted-constant pathology in its original form, and the tradition is the reason the pathology has an ancient name as well as a modern one. Derivation-first: confounded as written — and this is the census's sharpest single finding. The tradition derived its parameters from centuries of accurate records, reinterpreting existing data with no new apparatus, which is the signature's fourth point read naively; had the point's wording stood, this census would be certifying Ptolemy. The restatement writes itself here: derivation must yield structure — an invariant, a constant, a limit — not content, a position at a date. Everything the tradition derived was content. Conservative embedding: partial — the refinement ladder embedded each predecessor's devices, and the machinery is alive today: epicyclic superposition is Fourier analysis, any quasiperiodic motion a sum of uniform circles, so that the devices survive inside every Fourier series ever computed. But the census codes the point on ontology, and there the failure is clean — uniform circular motion as celestial necessity was deleted by Kepler's ellipse in 1609, not recovered as anyone's limit.

The remaining points complete the pattern. Formalism and meaning: partial — predictive machinery without minted measurables; angular position, in the inherited vocabulary, was all it ever output, and no instrument was ever built because the theory demanded one — where the ether at least caused the interferometer — while the physical mechanism stayed deferred, an instrumentalism the tradition wore as modesty and the census codes as the absence the sixth point names. Founders' resistance: satisfied — the tradition's institutional defenders resisted Copernicus, and Copernicus resisted the deeper cut; resistance, again, on both sides of the grave. Generative slope: positive for fourteen centuries, then negative — the equant's violation of the tradition's own uniformity principle was a running internal wound from the

Maragha school onward, and the fixes bought regularity with more circles, the count creeping upward as accuracy plateaued at whole degrees, never minutes; Copernicus inherited the wound and made it his opening. Crisis-chaining: partial — the tradition closed the demand to save the phenomena and opened the equant objection: a real crisis, and self-consuming — the door its executioner walked through.

Read as a pair, the tradition's natural experiment is the Tycho archive: observations made to serve the old construction's next refinement, consumed by Kepler to delete the circle — the same Mars data, the same instruments, the same records, two vocabularies. The pair carries a lesson the census states now and the amended signature will carry forward. Copernicus, the century's celebrated revolutionary, relocated the center and kept the circles — *De revolutionibus* is barely less epicyclic than the *Almagest*, comparable in circle count, comparable in accuracy, its own publisher anonymizing its preface into a defensive instrumentalism. The revolution the census's instrument detects did not arrive with the celebrated revolution; it arrived when Kepler deleted a constitutive concept — circularity itself, the inherited frame — and forced structure that predicted better with less. Vocabulary surgery, not content relocation, is what the discriminators discriminate; the tradition's fourteen centuries are standing evidence that everything else — the unification, the resistance, the crisis, even the data — can be had without it.

6. The Verdict: The Amended Signature

Table 2 assembles the census: nine points, three dead theories, twenty-seven cells, each coded with its named evidence. Read column-wise first. None of the three is empty — phlogiston satisfies two points cleanly and touches two more; the ether and the epicycles each satisfy three and touch four — and this is the census's first honesty check, passed: a coding in which the dead scored zero would indict the coder rather than the dead, for it would mean the soft points had been coded to the answer. Read row-wise second: no point came back untouched. The rows sort without coercion into two classes — points the dead satisfy, which the living also satisfy, and which therefore cannot discriminate; and points the dead fail, which the living pass, and which therefore can — plus a middle band that discriminates only after the audit's operationalizations are applied. The sorting is the census's result, and Table 3 renders it as verdicts.

Signature point	Phlogiston	The ether	Epicycles
Deletion at birth	F — renamed Becher's principle; added, deleted nothing	F — the inherited concept itself, carried forward unexamined	F — extended Eudoxus; circularity never touched
Unification	S — combustion, calcination, respiration as one principle	S — one medium under optics and electromagnetism	S — one construction for all seven wanderers
Universal constant	F — no quantitative core; weight forced phlogiston negative	F — c belonged to the fields and outlived the medium; the medium's own parameters fitted, then abandoned	F — dozens of parameters, zero invariants: the fitted-constant pathology in its original form
Derivation-first	F — each new gas retrofitted with new properties, after the fact	F — postulated by mechanical analogy; Maxwell's derivation stayed with the fields	confounded — parameters from centuries of records: content, never structure
Conservative embedding	F — deleted without remainder by oxygen chemistry	F — the medium recovered as no limit of anything; the contraction was the patch	P — devices survive as Fourier; the ontology deleted by the ellipse
Formalism / meaning	F — no formalism; no measurable ever minted	P — Lorentz's formalism complete; its meaning incoherent: aberration, drag, null — three ethers	P — machinery without minted measurables; the mechanism deferred
Founders' resistance	S — Priestley to the grave, 1804	S — Lorentz's preferred frame; Poincaré to 1912	S — the schools and the Church held the line
Generative slope	S then D — the gas family; then negative weight	S then D — Fresnel to the interferometer; then the incoherence triangle	S then D — fourteen centuries; then the equant wound
Crisis-chainin g	P — opened the air questions that killed it	P — opened its own motion problem; the null opened relativity	P — the equant objection opened its execution

Table 2 — The census matrix: nine signature points coded against the three dead theories. S satisfied, P partial, F failed, D degenerating; every cell's evidence is named in Chapters 3–5.

Four points discriminate, and each carries its amendment. Deletion at birth discriminates — all three dead theories added, inherited, or renamed, and none deleted — provided the coding is prospective, applied at the theory's christening rather than at its funeral; the point's original wording, demolition, invited hindsight, and the census rewrites it as the deletion test at birth. The universal constant discriminates — the dead have parameters, the living have constants — provided the point absorbs the audit's promotion test, since h itself was fitted at birth and became bedrock by paying independent derivations; the discriminator, sharpened, is the payment record, not the mint. Conservative embedding discriminates when coded on ontology: machinery survives everywhere — Fourier is the standing proof — but world-pictures are recovered only by the living. Generative slope discriminates when coded as a

trend rather than a level: all three dead programs were generative for longer than the survivors' entire careers, and all three ended paying more for less; the level prices ambition, the slope prices life. And the census notes without embarrassment that the slope criterion is Lakatos's progressive and degenerating problem shift, inherited whole — the chassis, carrying the discriminative load again.

One point discriminates only operationalized, and three are confounded outright. The formalism-and-meaning point, as Volume I wrote it, is satisfied by the ether — Lorentz's formalism was complete while its meaning was incoherent — so the point as written certifies the dead; it discriminates only in the sixth amendment's form, which demands minted measurables and one coherent discriminating list, and the ether fails exactly there. Unification is confounded three for three: every theory in this study, dead or alive, unified in its heroic phase; the point is true and empty as a discriminator, and it demotes — to a condition of ambition, joining Volume II's necessary conditions, where it should have stood all along. Founders' resistance is confounded: Priestley, Lorentz, and Poincaré resisted on the dead side; Newton, Einstein, and Planck resisted on the living one; resistance prices stakes, and demotes to a marker. Crisis-chaining is confounded, and its demotion is the census's one surprise: the dead theories opened real crises — the air questions, the motion of the medium, the equant wound — and their crises were productive, but for their successors; crisis-generative dynamism is a property of the research enterprise itself, not of profound theories, and the point moves to a corollary about ecosystems rather than a signature of depth.

Point	Census verdict	What the dead taught it	Disposition in v1.1
Deletion at birth	discriminates	all three dead theories added, inherited, or renamed — none deleted	kept — coded at the christening, not the funeral
Unification	confounded	satisfied three for three, as it is by the living	demoted to a condition of ambition (Volume II's column)
Universal constant	discriminates, amended	the dead have parameters, the living constants; h was fitted at birth and paid later	kept with the promotion test (A2)
Derivation-first	confounded as written	the epicycles: the premier reinterpreters of existing accurate data	restated — structure, not content
Conservative embedding	discriminates, on ontology	machinery survives (Fourier); world-pictures recovered only by the living	kept — ontology coded, machinery noted
Formalism / meaning	confounded as written; discriminates operationalized	Lorentz's ether held the complete formalism; the minted measurables were absent	kept in the sixth amendment's form (A6)
Founders' resistance	confounded	Priestley, Lorentz, and Poincaré resisted on the dead side	demoted to a marker of stakes
Generative slope	discriminates, as trend	generative for centuries, then paying more for less	kept with the counting rule (A6)
Crisis-chaining	confounded	the dead opened crises, productive for their successors	demoted to a corollary about ecosystems

Table 3 — Per-point verdicts: every signature claim paired with its confound and its disposition, at the point of claim — Amendment A4's second clause, executed.

The amended signature is the census's deliverable, and its falsifiers print with it, as Amendment A2 requires. The five discriminators — deletion at birth, the constant under its promotion test, ontological embedding, generative slope, and minted measurables with one coherent discriminating list — stand as the testable core, with derivation-first restated as the structure-not-content rule the epicycles forced. The three demoted points stand as true: unification, resistance, and crisis-chaining happen, reliably, at every level of the ladder and on both sides of the grave; they are conditions and symptoms, not discriminators, and Volume III's reissue marks them accordingly. The falsifiers are three, and each is executable: any future case the world ratifies as profound that fails a discriminator deletes that discriminator; any dead theory admitted under this rule that passes all five deletes the census; and any verdict above that an independent coder cannot reproduce deletes the coder — which is the last paragraph's subject.

The census's own limits are three, and they are stated at the weight the audit taught. First, the count: three pairs under a rule that admits few — the rule is the defense, the count is thin, and the extension protocol is fixed: widen the survivor base by Volume II's method, re-match, re-code, and print the differences.

Second, the coder: the signature's author coded its own controls, knowing the intended answers, and no blinding was possible where every verdict is famous; the executable fix is recoding by a process that has not read the series, and until it runs, every verdict in this document carries the coder's fingerprint. Third, fame: the residual of Chapter 2, named and standing. What the census does not claim is the larger arc: it has tested an instrument, not the world; it has made the signature smaller and harder, which is the only direction this series has ever endorsed; and it has left its deepest finding stated in one line — the points that made the doctrine dramatic are the points that died in the control, and the points that survived are work.

9 points coded against the dead no point came back untouched	5 discriminators after the census deletion, constant, embedding, slope, minted measurables	3 demoted as confounded unification, founders' resistance, crisis-chaining
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The census's own numbers: the signature that entered nine points wide leaves five discriminators deep.